

Struthiomimus

STROO-thee-oh-MIME-us

- **When** 75 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Canada
- **Habitat** Open country, riverbanks
- **Length** 15 ft (4 m)
- **Diet** Omnivorous

Struthiomimus was so similar to *Ornithomimus* that its fossil was for many years thought to be that of *Ornithomimus*. The only difference is that it had longer arms with stronger fingers. At the ends of its fingers were long, straight claws, but it probably could not use them to grasp prey, like *Ornithomimus* did. Instead, like modern sloths, *Struthiomimus* may have used its arms and hands to pull tree branches within reach of its beak. It probably ate buds and shoots from trees and other plants, but its diet

may also have included small animals and insects. Like other ornithomimids, *Struthiomimus* had long, powerful legs built for speed, and a small head perched on a slender, flexible neck.

▼ FEATHERS OR SCALES?

Most models and artworks show ornithomimids with scaly skin. However, many scientists now believe they had primitive, fuzzy feathers ("protofeathers"), in common with closely related dinosaur families.

Ornithomimus

OR-nith-oh-MIME-us

- **When** 75–65 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** USA, Canada
- **Habitat** Swamps, forests
- **Length** 10 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Omnivorous

Ornithomimus had the typical short body and long back legs of an ornithomimid. A fast runner, it could make sudden turns even while sprinting by swinging its tail from side to side. For its size and time, it had a fairly large brain, but was far less intelligent than an ostrich.

Long, stiff tail

